

# MedicalCause

A Schema.org Type

**Thing** > **MedicalEntity** > **MedicalCause**

[\[more...\]](#)

The causative agent(s) that are responsible for the pathophysiologic process that eventually results in a medical condition, symptom or sign. In this schema, unless otherwise specified this is meant to be the proximate cause of the medical condition, symptom or sign. The proximate cause is defined as the causative agent that most directly results in the medical condition, symptom or sign. For example, the HIV virus could be considered a cause of AIDS. Or in a diagnostic context, if a patient fell and sustained a hip fracture and two days later sustained a pulmonary embolism which eventuated in a cardiac arrest, the cause of the cardiac arrest (the proximate cause) would be the pulmonary embolism and not the fall. Medical causes can include cardiovascular, chemical, dermatologic, endocrine, environmental, gastroenterologic, genetic, hematologic, gynecologic, iatrogenic, infectious, musculoskeletal, neurologic, nutritional, obstetric, oncologic, otolaryngologic, pharmacologic, psychiatric, pulmonary, renal, rheumatologic, toxic, traumatic, or urologic causes; medical conditions can be causes as well.

| Property                             | Expected Type        | Description                                              |
|--------------------------------------|----------------------|----------------------------------------------------------|
| Properties from <b>MedicalCause</b>  |                      |                                                          |
| <b>causeOf</b>                       | <b>MedicalEntity</b> | The condition, complication, symptom, sign, etc. caused. |
| Properties from <b>MedicalEntity</b> |                      |                                                          |

| Property                     | Expected Type                                                               | Description                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
|------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>code</b>                  | <b>MedicalCode</b>                                                          | A medical code for the entity, taken from a controlled vocabulary or ontology such as ICD-9, DiseasesDB, MeSH, SNOMED-CT, RxNorm, etc.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
| <b>funding</b>               | <b>Grant</b>                                                                | A <b>Grant</b> that directly or indirectly provide funding or sponsorship for this item. See also <b>ownershipFundingInfo</b> .<br>Inverse property: <b>fundedItem</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
| <b>guideline</b>             | <b>MedicalGuideline</b>                                                     | A medical guideline related to this entity.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| <b>legalStatus</b>           | <b>DrugLegalStatus</b> or<br><b>MedicalEnumeration</b><br>or<br><b>Text</b> | The drug or supplement's legal status, including any controlled substance schedules that apply.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
| <b>medicineSystem</b>        | <b>MedicineSystem</b>                                                       | The system of medicine that includes this MedicalEntity, for example 'evidence-based', 'homeopathic', 'chiropractic', etc.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| <b>recognizingAuthority</b>  | <b>Organization</b>                                                         | If applicable, the organization that officially recognizes this entity as part of its endorsed system of medicine.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| <b>relevantSpecialty</b>     | <b>MedicalSpecialty</b>                                                     | If applicable, a medical specialty in which this entity is relevant.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
| <b>study</b>                 | <b>MedicalStudy</b>                                                         | A medical study or trial related to this entity.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| Properties from <b>Thing</b> |                                                                             |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
| <b>additionalType</b>        | <b>Text</b> or<br><b>URL</b>                                                | An additional type for the item, typically used for adding more specific types from external vocabularies in microdata syntax. This is a relationship between something and a class that the thing is in. Typically the value is a URI-identified RDF class, and in this case corresponds to the use of <code>rdf:type</code> in RDF. Text values can be used sparingly, for cases where useful information can be |

| Property                         | Expected Type                      | Description                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
|----------------------------------|------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|                                  |                                    | added without their being an appropriate schema to reference. In the case of text values, the class label should follow the schema.org <a href="#">style guide</a> .                                                                                                                                            |
| <b>alternateName</b>             | Text                               | An alias for the item.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
| <b>description</b>               | Text or<br>TextObject              | A description of the item.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
| <b>disambiguatingDescription</b> | Text                               | A sub property of description. A short description of the item used to disambiguate from other, similar items. Information from other properties (in particular, name) may be necessary for the description to be useful for disambiguation.                                                                    |
| <b>identifier</b>                | PropertyValue or<br>Text or<br>URL | The identifier property represents any kind of identifier for any kind of <b>Thing</b> , such as ISBNs, GTIN codes, UUIDs etc. Schema.org provides dedicated properties for representing many of these, either as textual strings or as URL (URI) links. See <a href="#">background notes</a> for more details. |
| <b>image</b>                     | ImageObject or<br>URL              | An image of the item. This can be a <a href="#">URL</a> or a fully described <b>ImageObject</b> .                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
| <b>mainEntityOfPage</b>          | CreativeWork or<br>URL             | Indicates a page (or other CreativeWork) for which this thing is the main entity being described. See <a href="#">background notes</a> for details.<br>Inverse property: <a href="#">mainEntity</a>                                                                                                             |
| <b>name</b>                      | Text                               | The name of the item.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
| <b>potentialAction</b>           | Action                             | Indicates a potential Action, which describes an idealized action in which this thing would play an 'object' role.                                                                                                                                                                                              |
|                                  |                                    |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |

| Property         | Expected Type         | Description                                                                                                                                                      |
|------------------|-----------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>sameAs</b>    | URL                   | URL of a reference Web page that unambiguously indicates the item's identity.<br>E.g. the URL of the item's Wikipedia page, Wikidata entry, or official website. |
| <b>subjectOf</b> | CreativeWork or Event | A CreativeWork or Event about this Thing.<br>Inverse property: <b>about</b>                                                                                      |
| <b>url</b>       | URL                   | URL of the item.                                                                                                                                                 |

## Examples

### 📄 Example 1

No Markup

Microdata

RDFa

**JSON-LD**

Structure

Example encoded as *JSON-LD* in a *HTML script tag*.

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<script type="application/ld+json">
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  "@type": "MedicalCondition",
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  "cause": [
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```

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"code": {
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  "code": "413",
  "codingSystem": "ICD-9"
},
"differentialDiagnosis": {
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  "diagnosis": {
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    "name": "heart attack"
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"distinguishingSign": [
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    "name": "chest pain lasting at least 10 minutes at rest"
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  {
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    "name": "repeated episodes of chest pain at rest lasting 5 or more minutes"
  }
],
```

```
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    "@type": "MedicalSymptom",
    "name": "feeling of tightness, heaviness, or pain in the chest"
  }
]
}
</script>
```



